

ANTON ROMANKOV

Senior Backend Engineer / Team Lead · Java · Distributed Systems · Data Platforms

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SUMMARY

Senior backend engineer and team lead with **13+ years** of building production systems, from low-level C++ to high-load Java microservices. I've maintained and evolved the core of an identity-verification (KYC) platform and designed a server-driven UI for a consumer app, a visual data platform for one of the world's largest digital banks, and network automation for Cisco's enterprise products.

I lead small backend teams while staying hands-on: I hire, mentor, run design reviews, and still ship code myself. I'm most useful where a system has to be rethought, not just maintained: I've rewritten search, storefront, OCR, and payroll engines, making each one faster, simpler, and easier to extend. I use AI in my daily work, from integrating LLMs into products with LangChain4j to working with coding agents such as Claude Code and Codex.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages	Java (8/11/17/21), Python, C++
Backend	Spring, Jakarta EE, Micronaut, Hibernate, REST, Event-Driven Architecture
Data & Streaming	PostgreSQL, Greenplum, MongoDB, Redis, Elasticsearch, Clickhouse, Cassandra, Kafka, RabbitMQ, Apache Flink, Apache Calcite, Hadoop, Iceberg, Parquet, S3
AI / LLM	LangChain4j, OCR + LLM Document Processing, Claude Code, Codex
Infrastructure	Docker, Kubernetes, GitLab CI/CD, GitHub Actions, TeamCity, Jenkins, Gradle, Maven, CMake, Linux
Testing	JUnit, Mockito, Testcontainers
Leadership	Team Leadership, System Design, Code Review, Mentoring, Technical Roadmap

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

 **Sumsu** **Jun 2024 – Jun 2026**
Batumi, Georgia

Backend Engineer / Team Lead

Sumsu is a global identity-verification and anti-fraud platform. I led a backend team of 4 engineers within the core team that owns the KYC pipeline, the product's main revenue flow.

- Owned the development and reliability of the KYC verification pipeline end to end (~**500K verifications/day**, 99.9% uptime): architecture, new features, production incidents, and large-scale refactoring.
- Led a team of 4 backend engineers:** ran sprint planning, design reviews, and code review.
- Brought NFC chip verification into the KYC pipeline:** designed and implemented cryptographic-grade validation of chip data in biometric passports and ID cards for **100+ countries**.
- Rebuilt the in-house OCR parsing engine**, combining OCR with LLM-based search (LangChain4j) to extract data from applicant documents, raising field extraction accuracy from **85% to 95%** and reducing manual review by **20%**.
- Rewrote the moderator salary engine** for **500+ moderators** as a configurable, fully testable rules model.

Stack: Java, Jakarta EE, MongoDB, Redis, S3, Kafka, Clickhouse, Docker, Kubernetes, GitLab CI/CD, LangChain4j

 **ToYou (via Setronica)** **Jun 2023 – Aug 2024**
Batumi, Georgia

Backend Engineer / Team Lead

ToYou is a super-app for food and grocery delivery in Saudi Arabia.

- Led a team of 3 engineers** responsible for the backend-for-frontend facade of the mobile app (**80K+ orders per day**, **1K RPS** at peak): personalized product catalog, search, and merchant storefronts.
- Designed a custom server-driven UI protocol** that lets the backend compose mobile app screens, so product teams ship UI changes and experiments without waiting for app store releases, cutting UI change lead time from **will be in next release to 1 minute**.
- Redesigned the search and merchant storefront engines behind a high-traffic app, **cutting PostgreSQL load by 25% and p95 latency by 40%**.

Stack: Java, Spring, PostgreSQL, Elasticsearch, Redis, Hibernate, Kafka, RabbitMQ, Kubernetes, GitHub Actions

Tinkoff

Senior Software Engineer

Aug 2021 – Jun 2023

Novosibirsk, Russia / Antalya, Turkey

Tinkoff is one of the world's largest fully digital banks.

- Built the backend of an **internal data discovery and preparation platform** (a Dremio-like product) where build ETL and analytics pipelines in a visual graph editor instead of writing SQL.
- **Designed the query engine**, built on Apache Calcite, that turns visual graphs into optimized SQL.
- **Built a Greenplum extension** that exposes Parquet/Iceberg data lake tables as native SQL tables, connecting the bank's warehouse to its lakehouse and giving analysts SQL access to **5 PB+** of data lake storage without copying data.
- Developed **streaming pipelines** on Apache Flink.

Stack: Java, Spring, Micronaut, Apache Calcite, Apache Flink, PostgreSQL, Greenplum, Cassandra, Hadoop, Iceberg, Parquet, Kubernetes

Cisco (through Xored)

Senior Software Engineer

Nov 2016 – Aug 2021

Novosibirsk, Russia

- Developed **Cisco Prime Infrastructure** and **Cisco DNA Center**, enterprise platforms that manage network infrastructure for Cisco customers worldwide.
- **Owned the configuration engine** that translates high-level network models into device configurations and deploys them to networks of up to **10K+ managed devices**.
- Worked directly with Cisco engineering teams over five years of continuous collaboration.

Stack: Java, Spring, PostgreSQL, Hibernate, Docker, Kubernetes

ICT SB RAS

Technical Lead (part-time)

Sep 2015 – Dec 2016

Novosibirsk, Russia

- **Led the development of a client-server seismic monitoring system** for RusHydro, Russia's largest hydropower company. The system runs on critical infrastructure and is in operation at the **Zeya Dam** and the **Nizhnekamsk Hydroelectric Station**.
- Designed the architecture: a C++ server and a Qt desktop client communicating over Protobuf/Asio.
- Co-authored a peer-reviewed paper on the system.

Stack: C++, Qt, Protobuf, Asio, SQLite, CMake, Linux

WiseMo (through Noveo)

Software Engineer

Jun 2013 – Nov 2016

Novosibirsk, Russia

- Developed a **cross-platform remote desktop product** (host and client) connecting any device to any other across Windows, Windows CE, Android, iOS, and Chrome PNaCl.
- Built shared C++ core logic and integrated it into the Android client through JNI.

Stack: C++, Java, JNI, CMake, Gradle

Intel

IT Intern

Mar 2007 – Dec 2007, Aug 2010 – Mar 2012

Novosibirsk, Russia

- Automated software deployment and virtualization across the data center using Bash, Python, and PowerShell; supported servers and workstations.

EDUCATION

N* Novosibirsk State University

B.Sc. in Mathematics

2008 – 2013

Faculty of Mechanics and Mathematics, Numerical Analysis

- Thesis: a high-accuracy Runge–Kutta/WENO method (fourth order in time, fifth order in space) for modeling wave propagation in saturated elastic porous media. Published in a peer-reviewed journal.
- Studied Applied Informatics at the IT Department of the same university (2004 – 2007).

PUBLICATIONS

- A Runge–Kutta/WENO method for small-amplitude wave propagation in a saturated elastic porous medium. DOI: [10.1134/S1995423914030045](https://doi.org/10.1134/S1995423914030045)
- Paper on the seismic monitoring system built for RusHydro (Seismic Instruments, 2018). DOI: [10.3103/S0747923918040114](https://doi.org/10.3103/S0747923918040114)

LANGUAGES

- **English:** B2 (professional working proficiency)

- **Russian:** Native